

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Hospitality and Tourism English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

02 Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

03 Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

04 Revenue Management and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

05 Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

06 Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Clarify missing information before responding.

07 Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Clarify missing information before responding.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

check-in - The process of registering an arrival; also a short meeting to review progress.

room inventory - The rooms available for sale or assignment under the property's current status definitions.

upgrade - A move to a higher service category, room type, or product capability.

service recovery - Actions taken to address a service failure and restore the customer's experience.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
 - B. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
 - C. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.
 - B. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - C. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Arrival confirmed, room not ready

Fictional hotel training: a corporate travel coordinator arrives with a guest group before rooms are ready; luggage storage is available, but readiness is unverified.

01 • Travel coordinator: Your confirmation said everything was ready. Our delegates expected to check in immediately.

02 • Front desk supervisor: I'm sorry our message confused confirmed reservations with rooms ready for occupancy.

03 • Travel coordinator: We have a meeting shortly. Can you give us an exact waiting time?

04 • Front desk supervisor: Not yet. Housekeeping hasn't confirmed readiness, and I shouldn't invent a time.

05 • Travel coordinator: Could you at least take the cases while we attend the meeting?

06 • Front desk supervisor: Yes, luggage storage is available. I'll also request an update on room inventory.

07 • Travel coordinator: Does that mean an upgrade is possible if our rooms remain unavailable?

08 • Front desk supervisor: I can ask, but no upgrade has been approved or confirmed available.

09 • Travel coordinator: Please store the luggage and contact me when you have verified information.

10 • Front desk supervisor: Certainly. I'll keep the room status separate from any service recovery request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The breakfast inclusion correction

Separate fictional case: a reservation lists room only, but an agent's welcome message incorrectly says breakfast included; a corporate booking manager calls.

01 • Booking manager: Your welcome message includes breakfast, but our travelers were asked to pay today.

02 • Reservations agent: I've checked the reservation. It says room only; my welcome message was incorrect.

03 • Booking manager: That mistake affects the meal budget I gave everyone before their arrival.

04 • Reservations agent: I'm sorry. I should have checked the booked package before sending that wording.

05 • Booking manager: Can you simply add breakfast to all six rooms for the remaining nights?

06 • Reservations agent: That requires approval. I can take the discrepancy to our front desk supervisor.

07 • Booking manager: Please don't describe this as guests misunderstanding the package they were offered.

08 • Reservations agent: Agreed. I'll explain that our message created an expectation the reservation doesn't match.

09 • Booking manager: Please give me the corrected booking details and tell me who is reviewing compensation.

10 • Reservations agent: I'll confirm the room-only status and identify the supervisor handling the service recovery request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A quiet-room request is not a guarantee

Separate fictional case: a tour leader's arrival sheet incorrectly calls a quiet-room request guaranteed; no alternative room has been verified.

01 • Tour leader: My arrival sheet guarantees courtyard rooms, but your colleague says they're only requested.

02 • Duty manager: You're right to question that. Our sheet overstated the status of the request.

03 • Tour leader: Several travelers chose this hotel because they wanted rooms away from street noise.

04 • Duty manager: I'm sorry we created that expectation. The courtyard preference is recorded, not guaranteed.

05 • Tour leader: What can you actually do before I distribute the room keys today?

06 • Duty manager: I'll check current room inventory and ask reception to explain verified options individually.

07 • Tour leader: Can I announce that everyone will receive an upgrade instead of a courtyard room?

08 • Duty manager: No upgrade is confirmed. Please tell them we're checking assignments, without promising an alternative.

09 • Tour leader: I'll correct the announcement, but I need one contact for any further concerns.

10 • Duty manager: I'll be that contact and review the service recovery options after checking availability.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Scenario 2 | An arrival entrance changes

In a fictional hotel, a conference group's confirmation names the main entrance, but its booked reception desk is at the garden entrance. Both entrances are open; luggage assistance has not been confirmed. Correct the message by phone before arrival.

Role A: Front desk supervisor: acknowledge the incorrect entrance instruction and explain the verified reception location.

Role B: Conference coordinator: explain that delegates have the old instruction and ask about luggage assistance.

Possible opening: Our confirmation named the wrong reception entrance, and I want to correct that before your group arrives.

Success checks

- Take responsibility for the incorrect message.
- Distinguish the confirmed entrance from unconfirmed assistance.
- Agree how the coordinator will pass on the correction.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks you to guarantee that a porter will meet the coach, but availability is unknown.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

SITUATION

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

guest complaint - A guest's expression of dissatisfaction with a hospitality service.

online review - Public feedback posted on a digital platform about a product or experience.

brand voice - The recognizable style and tone a brand uses in communication.

compensation - Payment or another remedy; in employment, the pay and benefits provided for work.

3. Notice the language

Use a specific example instead of a personality label. Explain its effect, invite the person's perspective, and agree on a practical improvement. Focus on communication that can be changed, not accent or national identity.

In [specific situation], I noticed ...

The effect was ... What was happening from your perspective?

Could we agree to ... and review it ...?

Compare this wording: You are always careless.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give feedback people can use

4. Check the language

1. Which feedback begins with observable behavior?
 - A. I think the team needs to be more committed to the updates.
 - B. The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.
 - C. The last two updates seemed less professional than usual.
2. Which follow-up invites useful information before agreeing on support?
 - A. What is making this part of the task difficult?
 - B. Can you promise this will never happen again?
 - C. Would another reminder solve this problem?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Remove the booking details from the reply

Fictional review meeting: a draft public response quotes a guest's booking reference and disputes the complaint; nothing has been posted.

01 • Guest relations manager: Your draft includes the booking reference and says the guest's account is completely wrong.

02 • Social media coordinator: I wanted readers to see that we had actually checked the guest complaint.

03 • Guest relations manager: The reference exposes booking details, and the accusation makes our brand voice sound defensive.

04 • Social media coordinator: I see the privacy concern. How can we show we're taking the complaint seriously?

05 • Guest relations manager: Acknowledge the reported experience, then invite a private conversation through our established contact channel.

06 • Social media coordinator: Should we mention compensation publicly so other readers know we're offering a solution?

07 • Guest relations manager: Nothing is approved. A public promise would create another expectation we might not meet.

08 • Social media coordinator: I'll remove the reference and replace the argument with an invitation to follow up privately.

09 • Guest relations manager: Good. What made the original response difficult to write in a neutral way?

10 • Social media coordinator: I confused correcting facts with arguing. Please review the revision with me before publication.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The apology that ignored the noise

Separate fictional case: a hotel response thanks a reviewer for praising breakfast but ignores their detailed noise complaint.

01 • Quality manager: The reply mentions breakfast twice, but it never acknowledges the reported overnight noise.

02 • Guest relations agent: I focused on the positive comment because we haven't verified the noise source.

03 • Quality manager: That makes the guest complaint look ignored. Acknowledging their report doesn't confirm its cause.

04 • Guest relations agent: So I can say we're sorry their sleep was disturbed without blaming maintenance?

05 • Quality manager: Yes. Keep the cause open and explain how they can discuss the experience privately.

06 • Guest relations agent: Would promising that the noise will never happen again make the apology stronger?

07 • Quality manager: It would make an unsupported promise. Our brand voice should be courteous and credible.

08 • Guest relations agent: I'll acknowledge the disturbance and offer a private follow-up without guaranteeing a technical fix.

09 • Quality manager: That addresses the omission. Could we check the next three replies for the same pattern?

10 • Guest relations agent: Certainly. I'll make sure each reply responds to the specific concern, not just compliments.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Feedback on an interrupted complaint call

Separate fictional coaching case: a supervisor and reservations agent review a training call in which the agent interrupts a conference organizer twice.

01 • Reservations supervisor: During the practice call, you interrupted twice while the organizer was describing the billing concern.

02 • Reservations agent: I thought I already understood it and wanted to resolve the guest complaint quickly.

03 • Reservations supervisor: The organizer then repeated the story. That lengthened the call and increased frustration.

04 • Reservations agent: I noticed that too. Should I stay silent until every detail has been explained?

05 • Reservations supervisor: Let the main concern finish, then summarize it and ask one focused question.

06 • Reservations agent: What if the organizer requests compensation before I have checked the billing record?

07 • Reservations supervisor: Acknowledge the request without approving it. Explain which details you need to review first.

08 • Reservations agent: I'll practice saying, 'You're questioning the room charge; have I understood the concern correctly?'

09 • Reservations supervisor: Good. Let's replay the opening and see whether that gives the organizer room to respond.

10 • Reservations agent: Afterward, please tell me whether my summary captures the concern without assuming an outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

Second round: The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Model for scenario 1: Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Scenario 2 | A reply sounds copied

A fictional hotel's response to a complaint about a missed wake-up call thanks the guest for their restaurant feedback. The response is still a draft. Hold a coaching conversation and agree one check before posting.

Role A: Guest relations supervisor: identify the exact mismatch and its likely effect without criticizing personality.

Role B: Trainee: explain that you reused a draft and ask how to check relevance efficiently.

Possible opening: This draft refers to restaurant feedback, but the guest complained about a missed wake-up call.

Success checks

- Describe the observed mismatch rather than labeling the trainee.
- Invite the trainee's perspective.
- Agree a specific check that preserves a courteous brand voice.

Add a complication: The trainee says using a template is necessary during busy periods.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

overbooking - Accepting more reservations than the available capacity based on expected cancellations or no-shows.

walk - In hospitality, relocating a guest to another property when the booked accommodation cannot be supplied.

occupancy - The proportion of available rooms occupied or sold during a stated period.

rate parity - An arrangement concerning consistency of hotel rates across specified distribution channels.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - B. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
 - C. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - B. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.
 - C. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Twin rooms or a partner property

Fictional overbooking case: a hotel authorizes either two twin rooms onsite or two doubles at a partner property for one night at the booked total; transport is not yet arranged.

01 • Reservations manager: Our overbooking means the two doubles are unavailable tonight. We have two approved alternatives.

02 • Tour coordinator: The travelers need separate rooms, but they strongly prefer the double beds they booked.

03 • Reservations manager: They can take two twins here or two doubles at our partner property tonight.

04 • Tour coordinator: Would a walk to the partner property change the total accommodation charge for them?

05 • Reservations manager: For this arrangement, the booked total stays the same. Transport still needs arranging.

06 • Tour coordinator: Then I can't accept it until I know how they'll reach the other hotel.

07 • Reservations manager: Understood. If the transfer arrangements suit them, we can proceed with that alternative.

08 • Tour coordinator: Please check transport first. I won't announce a confirmed move while that remains open.

09 • Reservations manager: I'll coordinate the transfer request and keep the onsite twin option clear in our discussion.

10 • Tour coordinator: Once you have those details, I'll ask the travelers which tradeoff they prefer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Keeping a three-night stay together

Separate fictional case: a group can book six standard rooms for three nights or six superior rooms for two nights followed by a move to standard rooms; quoted totals are equal.

01 • Group sales agent: We can keep six standard rooms for all three nights, or offer superior rooms initially.

02 • Event planner: Initially sounds uncertain. How many nights would those superior rooms actually cover for this group?

03 • Group sales agent: Two nights, followed by a move to standard rooms. Both quoted totals are equal.

04 • Event planner: Our final morning is busy. Can you guarantee the move won't interrupt the program?

05 • Group sales agent: I can't guarantee that. Staying in standard rooms avoids that planned room change entirely.

06 • Event planner: The upgrade is attractive, but moving luggage matters more than the larger room size.

07 • Group sales agent: Then the standard allocation may fit better, provided your delegates accept that room category.

08 • Event planner: I'll take that choice to them. Please don't release the booking as superior rooms.

09 • Group sales agent: I'll record the proposed standard allocation and request your decision before confirming the rooming list.

10 • Event planner: Good. I'll explain the room-category and room-change tradeoff instead of describing the options as identical.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Comparing channel offers fairly

Separate fictional reservation case: a direct offer includes breakfast and flexible cancellation; an agency offer is room only with different cancellation terms. No matched rate has been authorized.

01 • Corporate travel buyer: The agency rate is lower. Can you match it and keep your direct-booking benefits?

02 • Revenue coordinator: The offers differ: ours includes breakfast and flexible cancellation; the agency's is room only.

03 • Corporate travel buyer: I thought rate parity meant the same room always had exactly the same price.

04 • Revenue coordinator: We need to compare the actual offers and terms, not assume those packages are equivalent.

05 • Corporate travel buyer: Our travelers need breakfast, but their dates are fixed. Could you quote that combination?

06 • Revenue coordinator: I can request a separate quote. I can't confirm a matched rate without approval.

07 • Corporate travel buyer: Then give me the existing choices while the tailored quote is under review.

08 • Revenue coordinator: You can consider the flexible breakfast package or the agency's room-only offer under its conditions.

09 • Corporate travel buyer: I'll compare the full stay cost and cancellation terms before asking anyone to book.

10 • Revenue coordinator: I'll identify the pending quote clearly so it isn't mistaken for an approved reservation offer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Scenario 2 | One room category for a later arrival

A fictional retreat can reserve four identical rooms starting Wednesday, or two standard and two superior rooms starting Tuesday. The retreat organizer prefers Tuesday and identical rooms. No further inventory is confirmed. Negotiate a proposal for organizer approval.

Role A: Reservations coordinator: offer the two verified allocations and make the date or room-category tradeoff explicit.

Role B: Retreat planner: decide which compromise to propose to your director, without claiming their approval.

Possible opening: We can keep the room category consistent from Wednesday, or accommodate Tuesday arrival with two categories.

Success checks

- Compare both allocations accurately.
- State what requires the director's approval.
- Avoid promising future room availability.

Add a complication: The planner asks you to promise that Tuesday inventory will improve tomorrow.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Revenue Management and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

ADR - Average daily rate: room revenue divided by rooms sold for the stated period.

RevPAR - Revenue per available room: room revenue divided by available rooms for the stated period.

yield management - Adjusting price and availability to manage revenue from limited, time-sensitive capacity.

compression night - A hotel-market period of strong demand and limited room availability.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - B. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Higher room price, lower room revenue

Fictional daily comparison: 100 available rooms on each day; day one sells 80 at an average of 100 units, day two sells 60 at 120 units. Figures exclude other revenue.

01 • Hotel manager: Average daily rate increased from 100 to 120. Surely room revenue improved as well.

02 • Revenue analyst: Not in this example. We sold 80 rooms before, but only 60 on the second day.

03 • Hotel manager: I understand occupancy fell, but how does that affect the measure on this slide?

04 • Revenue analyst: RevPAR is room revenue per available room. It includes the effect of unsold rooms.

05 • Hotel manager: So ADR describes the rooms sold, while RevPAR also reflects the available room inventory?

06 • Revenue analyst: Exactly. Room revenue was 8,000, then 7,200, across the same 100 available rooms.

07 • Hotel manager: That gives RevPAR of 80 and 72, despite the higher average selling price.

08 • Revenue analyst: Correct. Neither measure alone tells us profit, because we haven't included the relevant costs.

09 • Hotel manager: I'll explain the price increase and occupancy decline together in the management briefing.

10 • Revenue analyst: Good. Keep the comparison limited to these two days and these room-revenue figures.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A compression night is not every night

Separate fictional case: the hotel has high demand on Saturday during a convention, but Friday and Sunday bookings remain lower.

01 • Conference sales manager: You called Saturday a compression night. Does that mean the entire weekend is sold out?

02 • Revenue manager: No. Here it describes concentrated demand on Saturday; Friday and Sunday bookings are still lower.

03 • Conference sales manager: Then why does the proposed group quote show different prices across the three nights?

04 • Revenue manager: The proposal reflects those different demand conditions. Yield management considers when and how inventory is sold.

05 • Conference sales manager: Could I explain it as charging every convention guest more because they must attend?

06 • Revenue manager: That would misrepresent the proposal. Explain the specific nightly prices and conditions without guessing guests' motives.

07 • Conference sales manager: Would higher Saturday demand establish that the whole three-night package produces better revenue?

08 • Revenue manager: We'd still need the full booking mix and room revenue across all three nights.

09 • Conference sales manager: I'll describe Saturday separately and avoid saying the entire weekend has identical demand.

10 • Revenue manager: That distinction will help the planner compare the package without confusing a peak with the average.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Room revenue is not total event revenue

Separate fictional case: a conference booking includes 4,000 units of room revenue and 2,000 of banquet revenue; a trainee puts 6,000 into the hotel's room-revenue measure.

01 • Revenue controller: Your calculation includes banquet revenue in the room-revenue total. Can we separate those amounts?

02 • Management trainee: The conference brought in 6,000 overall, so I thought all of it belonged in RevPAR.

03 • Revenue controller: For this report, RevPAR uses room revenue. The banquet amount belongs in its own category.

04 • Management trainee: Then 4,000 is the room component, and 2,000 belongs to food and event service?

05 • Revenue controller: Correct. Combining them would make this booking look stronger against a room-only comparison unfairly.

06 • Management trainee: Does separating the figures mean the banquet business is less valuable to the hotel?

07 • Revenue controller: No. It means we're keeping the measures consistent before discussing the total business contribution.

08 • Management trainee: I'll show room revenue and banquet revenue separately, then give the combined total below.

09 • Revenue controller: Good. What additional information would you need before calling that total a profit figure?

10 • Management trainee: The associated costs. Revenue tells us what came in, not what remains after expenses.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Revenue Management and Pricing

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Scenario 2 | An average hides two room types

A fictional report shows a higher ADR this week, but more suites were sold and standard-room prices were unchanged. No profit data are supplied. Explain the possible booking-mix effect to a sales colleague.

Role A: Revenue analyst: distinguish a higher average selling rate from an increase in every room's price.

Role B: Sales coordinator: paraphrase the distinction and ask what comparison would clarify it.

Possible opening: The average rate rose, but that does not mean the standard-room price increased.

Success checks

- Explain ADR in familiar words.
- Identify the change in room mix.
- Avoid inferring profit without cost information.

Add a complication: The coordinator wants to tell the team that every room became more profitable.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

room status - A room's recorded availability or service condition, such as occupied or out of order.

out of order - A room or item unavailable for normal use because of a problem or required work.

turnover - Preparing a room for the next guest; in staffing, the rate of people leaving an organization.

preventive maintenance - Planned work intended to reduce failures and maintain equipment condition.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
 - B. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - C. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?
 - B. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - C. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Cleaned is not released

Fictional shift handoff: room 214 is cleaned, but its maintenance repair request remains open and its assignment status has not been cleared.

01 • Housekeeping supervisor: Room 214 has been cleaned, but the maintenance request remains open on our handover list.

02 • Front desk lead: The cleaning update reached reception. Does that mean I can assign the room now?

03 • Housekeeping supervisor: No release is recorded. Cleaned describes our work, not confirmation that the repair is complete.

04 • Front desk lead: Who has accepted the follow-up? I don't want another shift assuming someone checked it.

05 • Housekeeping supervisor: I still own the follow-up and will contact maintenance for the outstanding repair status.

06 • Front desk lead: Please keep the room status clear while you do that; our arrival queue is growing.

07 • Housekeeping supervisor: Understood. I'll report the verified status to you rather than estimating when it becomes available.

08 • Front desk lead: So 214 is cleaned, repair unresolved, and you are checking with maintenance. Correct?

09 • Housekeeping supervisor: Correct. Any release must come through the hotel's authorized room-status process after that check.

10 • Front desk lead: I've accepted the reception handoff and will ensure the cleaning note isn't treated as release.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An out-of-order room carries into tomorrow

Separate fictional case: room 509 is out of order pending a replacement part; the supplier has not confirmed delivery. An incoming maintenance coordinator takes over supplier follow-up.

01 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Room 509 remains out of order. The replacement part is requested, but delivery isn't confirmed.

02 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: Has anyone told reception that tomorrow's turnover can include it in available inventory?

03 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: No. Our last update said the delivery timing was unknown and the repair remained open.

04 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: I'll take supplier follow-up. Where is the part reference and the most recent contact recorded?

05 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Both are in the maintenance request for 509, with the last call marked unanswered.

06 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: An unanswered call isn't supplier acceptance. I'll keep that distinction in the next update.

07 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Thank you. Please also tell reception who now owns the follow-up on this room.

08 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: I'll confirm ownership to reception and report the supplier's response without promising a release date.

09 • Outgoing maintenance coordinator: Can you repeat the current status so I know the key information transferred correctly?

10 • Incoming maintenance coordinator: 509 stays out of order; delivery and repair are pending, and I own supplier follow-up.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A preventive visit clashes with a group arrival

Separate fictional case: preventive maintenance is booked for room 318 tomorrow morning, and a new group allocation lists the same room; no revised appointment is approved.

01 • Rooms coordinator: Tomorrow's group allocation includes 318, but preventive maintenance is still scheduled there that morning.

02 • Maintenance planner: Thanks for flagging it. Has the room allocation already been communicated as final to the group?

03 • Rooms coordinator: It's an internal draft. I haven't confirmed that room number to the tour coordinator.

04 • Maintenance planner: Then please keep the conflict visible. A proposed allocation doesn't cancel the maintenance appointment.

05 • Rooms coordinator: Can you take responsibility for checking whether the appointment can move without affecting the plan?

06 • Maintenance planner: Yes, I'll ask the authorized scheduler. I cannot approve that change myself during this handoff.

07 • Rooms coordinator: I'll retain ownership of the group allocation and wait for your scheduling update.

08 • Maintenance planner: To confirm, you manage room assignment, and I check the unresolved preventive maintenance conflict.

09 • Rooms coordinator: Exactly. Neither of us should mark the room available on the strength of this conversation.

10 • Maintenance planner: Agreed. I'll return a confirmed scheduling status, or clearly state that approval is still pending.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Scenario 2 | The linen delivery handoff

A fictional hotel has received twelve of twenty requested linen bundles. Eight are outstanding, and the delivery time is unknown. The evening supervisor must take over supplier contact and keep reception informed about turnover capacity.

Role A: Day housekeeping supervisor: hand over received and missing quantities and request explicit acceptance.

Role B: Evening housekeeping supervisor: accept supplier follow-up and ask what cannot yet be promised to reception.

Possible opening: Twelve linen bundles are here; eight remain outstanding, and their arrival time is unconfirmed.

Success checks

- Repeat back the received and outstanding quantities.
- Name the person taking supplier follow-up.
- Do not convert missing delivery information into a room-ready promise.

Add a complication: Reception asks whether all remaining rooms will be ready in one hour.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

BEO - Banquet event order: a document specifying arrangements and responsibilities for an event.

run of show - A timed sequence of an event's activities and responsibilities.

attrition - An agreed reduction in booked event rooms or attendance, sometimes subject to charges.

AV requirement - An audio or visual equipment need for an event, such as microphones or projection.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

What does sound check include?

Fictional banquet planning call: the run of show lists sound check without a room, time, or owner; the organizer knows the presenter needs a wireless microphone.

01 • Banquet coordinator: The run of show lists sound check, but it doesn't identify a room or responsible contact.

02 • Event organizer: I assumed your venue arranged that automatically. Our presenter needs a wireless microphone for the talk.

03 • Banquet coordinator: Could you clarify whether sound check means testing that microphone or rehearsing the whole presentation?

04 • Event organizer: Only the microphone test is required. I haven't arranged a full rehearsal with the presenter.

05 • Banquet coordinator: Which event room should we use? I shouldn't infer that from the incomplete schedule entry.

06 • Event organizer: That still needs confirmation. Can we identify the missing decisions before choosing a test time?

07 • Banquet coordinator: Yes. We need the room, presenter availability, and the AV contact who accepts the task.

08 • Event organizer: I'll confirm the room and presenter availability; can you identify the appropriate venue contact?

09 • Banquet coordinator: I can request that assignment. I'll keep the AV requirement pending in the banquet event order.

10 • Event organizer: Then no sound check is confirmed yet. We'll agree the time once those details are available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Doors open for whom?

Separate fictional event case: a schedule says doors open at 17:00; suppliers need access, and attendees arrive at 18:00. The meaning of the 17:00 entry is unclear.

01 • Venue operations manager: Your schedule says doors open at five. Does that refer to suppliers or invited attendees?

02 • Conference producer: Attendees arrive at six, but I can't tell whether the five o'clock entry means supplier access.

03 • Venue operations manager: That distinction affects staffing. Could you confirm who created the entry before we brief the team?

04 • Conference producer: I'll ask the production assistant. In the meantime, let's label attendee arrival separately at six.

05 • Venue operations manager: Agreed. Do suppliers need loading access only, or access to the event room as well?

06 • Conference producer: That hasn't been specified. I should collect their access requirements instead of assuming both.

07 • Venue operations manager: Please include the access point and receiving contact when you confirm the run of show.

08 • Conference producer: Would you like me to call once those points are verified, before circulating the revised schedule?

09 • Venue operations manager: Yes. We can then check that the banquet event order and staffing brief use the same wording.

10 • Conference producer: I'll confirm the five o'clock meaning and supplier requirements; six remains the verified attendee arrival time.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A guarantee is not an attendance forecast

Separate fictional planning case: a draft BEO lists 90 expected attendees and a separate guaranteed count of 80; the organizer asks what number catering should prepare against.

01 • Catering manager: The banquet event order shows 90 expected attendees and a guaranteed count of 80.

02 • Association planner: I thought those were two labels for the same number. Which entry are you asking about?

03 • Catering manager: I'm asking which count has been agreed for service planning under this event's arrangements.

04 • Association planner: The forecast is 90, but I haven't checked the agreement behind the guaranteed count.

05 • Catering manager: Then we should verify that before changing quantities or making any statement about attrition charges.

06 • Association planner: Could you clarify what document and section your team needs me to check first?

07 • Catering manager: Please check the event agreement's attendance and catering provisions, then confirm the current approved count.

08 • Association planner: I'll ask our authorized organizer to review them. Can the forecast remain clearly labeled meanwhile?

09 • Catering manager: Yes. Expected attendance and an agreed guarantee should stay separate in the BEO until clarified.

10 • Association planner: Understood. I'll return with the approved count rather than treating my attendance estimate as authorization.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Scenario 2 | Which screen needs the live feed?

A fictional event's AV requirement says live feed. A lobby screen and a stage screen are available, but the requested destination and content are unspecified. The producer and AV coordinator must clarify these before requesting a test.

Role A: AV coordinator: ask focused questions about the screen and intended content.

Role B: Event producer: confirm the lobby screen is intended, but acknowledge that the camera view has not been selected.

Possible opening: When the run of show says live feed, which screen should receive it?

Success checks

- Identify the lobby as the confirmed destination.
- Keep the camera view and testing status open.
- Agree who will obtain the remaining content decision.

Add a complication: The producer asks you to mark the AV requirement complete before the camera view is agreed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

itinerary - A planned sequence of travel activities, locations, and times.

force majeure - A contractual provision addressing specified events beyond a party's control; effects depend on the wording and law.

waiver - A documented relinquishment or exception concerning a right or requirement, subject to applicable terms and law.

local operator - A provider responsible for delivering travel or tour services in a destination.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Weather concern without a departure decision

Fictional excursion coordination: heavy weather may affect a trip; the local operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed.

01 • Hotel concierge: Guests are asking whether tomorrow's excursion will follow the original itinerary despite the weather.

02 • Tour operations coordinator: Heavy weather may affect it, but the local operator hasn't confirmed a departure decision yet.

03 • Hotel concierge: The booking remains visible online. Can I treat that as confirmation the trip is proceeding?

04 • Tour operations coordinator: No. A visible booking isn't an operational update, and we shouldn't make that inference.

05 • Hotel concierge: What can I tell the group without making the situation sound more certain than it is?

06 • Tour operations coordinator: Say the itinerary is under review and we're awaiting the operator's confirmed status.

07 • Hotel concierge: Should I also say their waiver means the excursion is safe to run in this weather?

08 • Tour operations coordinator: No. A waiver doesn't establish current conditions or replace the operator's authorized safety decision.

09 • Hotel concierge: I'll keep the departure status unconfirmed and direct operational questions through your contact.

10 • Tour operations coordinator: I'll request the verified update and separate any itinerary change from unanswered refund questions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A photograph is not a trail assessment

Separate fictional tour case: a guide receives an old photograph of a wet trail; no current route assessment has been provided by the local operator.

01 • Tour guide: A traveler shared a wet-trail photograph and says it proves tomorrow's route is closed.

02 • Excursion manager: Do we know when the photograph was taken or whether it shows our planned route?

03 • Tour guide: It's from last month, and the location hasn't been verified against the itinerary.

04 • Excursion manager: Then it doesn't establish today's route status. We need the local operator's current assessment.

05 • Tour guide: Can I dismiss the concern because the photograph is old and might show somewhere else?

06 • Excursion manager: Don't dismiss it. Acknowledge the concern while explaining why this evidence doesn't settle the question.

07 • Tour guide: I'll say we haven't confirmed a closure or established that the route is suitable.

08 • Excursion manager: That's accurate. Ask the operator for the current route status through our coordination channel.

09 • Tour guide: Until that arrives, I'll avoid proposing an alternative trail based on my own assumptions.

10 • Excursion manager: Good. Any revised itinerary needs the appropriate review, not just a reassuring answer to the group.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Cancellation does not settle the contract question

Separate fictional case: a local operator has confirmed cancellation of a harbor tour due to weather; the hotel's coordinator has not reviewed the booking's refund terms.

01 • Travel coordinator: The harbor tour is canceled because of weather. Does force majeure mean nobody receives a refund?

02 • Excursion supervisor: We have a confirmed cancellation, but we haven't reviewed the relevant terms for these bookings.

03 • Travel coordinator: The operator used that phrase in its message. I assumed it settled the payment question.

04 • Excursion supervisor: It doesn't let us infer each traveler's contractual position from this message alone.

05 • Travel coordinator: So the cancellation is known, while the refund outcome still needs an authorized review?

06 • Excursion supervisor: Exactly. We can explain the confirmed itinerary change and refer the payment question for review.

07 • Travel coordinator: Guests will want a definite answer. Can we at least promise a replacement tour?

08 • Excursion supervisor: No replacement is confirmed. We can ask about options without presenting them as approved compensation.

09 • Travel coordinator: I'll separate the operational announcement from the unresolved refund and alternative-tour questions.

10 • Excursion supervisor: Please do. I'll gather the booking terms and operator notice for the appropriate reviewer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Scenario 2 | A museum stop may be unavailable

A fictional tour includes a museum. Its public page mentions building work but gives no closure dates, and the local operator has not verified access for the booked day. Discuss what can be said to the group.

Role A: Tour planner: explain the evidence and ask the operator to verify the booked visit.

Role B: Hotel concierge: challenge a proposed announcement that the museum stop is canceled.

Possible opening: The museum mentions building work, but we haven't established whether it affects our booked visit.

Success checks

- Distinguish the published notice from a verified closure.
- Avoid guaranteeing or canceling the visit without confirmation.
- Agree who will seek the operator's update.

Add a complication: A traveler asks whether the unchanged itinerary on their voucher proves access is guaranteed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

service standard - A stated expectation for how a service should be delivered.

cultural expectation - An expectation shaped by experience and social context; it should not be assumed from nationality alone.

guest profile - Relevant recorded preferences and service information about a guest, handled under applicable privacy rules.

recovery gesture - An authorized service action intended to help address a disappointing guest experience.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ask before interpreting a declined service

Fictional staff coaching: a guest declines luggage assistance; a porter attributes the choice to nationality, although the guest gave no reason.

01 • Porter: The guest declined luggage assistance. People from that country probably prefer carrying everything themselves.

02 • Guest services supervisor: We don't know that. What did the guest actually say when you offered the service?

03 • Porter: Only 'No, thank you.' They didn't explain why they preferred not to use it.

04 • Guest services supervisor: Then respect the choice without adding a cultural explanation to the guest profile.

05 • Porter: Should I ask them why they refused, so we can improve our service standard?

06 • Guest services supervisor: There's no need to press for a reason. Ask about future assistance only if it's useful.

07 • Porter: I could say, 'Would you like us to leave you to settle in, or help later?'

08 • Guest services supervisor: Yes, provided it doesn't become repeated pressure after they've clearly declined assistance.

09 • Porter: I'll record only a relevant stated preference, not a guess about nationality or personality.

10 • Guest services supervisor: Good. Our service can respond to the individual without treating an assumption as a cultural expectation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A recovery gesture needs a preference check

Separate fictional case: a hotel may offer flowers or a fruit basket as an approved recovery gesture; neither has been selected for a corporate traveler.

01 • Guest relations coordinator: We can offer flowers or a fruit basket after the room mix-up. Which should we send?

02 • Duty manager: Have we asked the traveler whether they would welcome either recovery gesture in their room?

03 • Guest relations coordinator: No. I assumed flowers would be more appropriate based on the guest's profile photograph.

04 • Duty manager: A photograph doesn't tell us that preference. We should offer the options without making that assumption.

05 • Guest relations coordinator: Could asking spoil the gesture and make the apology feel less personal to them?

06 • Duty manager: It can be considerate. Explain the options briefly and make clear that declining is perfectly acceptable.

07 • Guest relations coordinator: I'll ask, 'Would either option be welcome, or would you prefer no delivery?'

08 • Duty manager: That works. Don't infer dietary preferences from the guest's name when discussing the fruit basket.

09 • Guest relations coordinator: I'll confirm the choice directly and record only what is needed for this delivery.

10 • Duty manager: Then the gesture supports the apology rather than imposing our idea of good service.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Formal or first-name introductions

Separate fictional case: an event host asks a hotel team how to address an international delegation; delegates have not provided individual preferences.

01 • Event host: Should the reception team use first names for everyone? The delegation is attending an informal retreat.

02 • Front office trainer: Informal describes the event, but it doesn't confirm every delegate's preferred form of address.

03 • Event host: We have names on the rooming list. Could we choose a style based on their countries?

04 • Front office trainer: That would substitute a national assumption for an individual preference we can ask about respectfully.

05 • Event host: How can the team ask without turning each check-in into an awkward interview?

06 • Front office trainer: A simple 'How would you prefer us to address you?' allows a direct answer.

07 • Event host: And if someone doesn't express a preference, should we invent one for the guest profile?

08 • Front office trainer: No. Follow our service standard while keeping any unconfirmed preference out of the record.

09 • Event host: I'll brief the team to ask naturally and use the answer consistently during the stay.

10 • Front office trainer: Good. Clarifying a preference is more reliable than trying to predict it from a nationality.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Cultural Expectations and Service Style

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Scenario 2 | How should reception contact the organizer?

A fictional organizer is in meetings between 10:00 and 12:00. Reception can use a phone call or a written message for routine room updates. Their preferred channel is unknown. Agree a communication preference by speaking before the meetings.

Role A: Reception supervisor: ask which available channel the organizer prefers for routine updates.

Role B: Event organizer: choose written messages during the meetings and phone calls afterward.

Possible opening: Which contact method would work best for routine room updates while you're in meetings?

Success checks

- Ask the individual rather than infer a group preference.
- Repeat the two time-dependent channel choices accurately.
- Limit the agreement to routine updates rather than inventing emergency procedures.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests inferring the preference from the organizer's age instead of asking.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

B: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

C: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

Check 2: B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

B: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

C: The reader still lacks the information they need.

Model response: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Editing example: The last two reports omitted the agreed summary section.

The revision identifies observable work. 'Always' and a personality judgment make the feedback harder to verify or act on.

Check 1: B - The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.

A: Commitment is an interpretation, not a description of what the updates contained.

B: The recipient can check the specific examples and discuss how to improve them.

C: "Less professional" is an evaluation; it does not identify a specific observable omission.

Check 2: A - What is making this part of the task difficult?

A: An open question may reveal a barrier the speaker has not considered.

B: A promise does not reveal the obstacle or what support would help.

C: This proposes a solution before finding out what is making the task difficult.

Model response: Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

B: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

C: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

Check 2: C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

B: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

C: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

Model response: The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Revenue Management and Pricing

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

B: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

Model response: The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

B: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

C: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

Check 2: A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

B: It changes pending information into a final result.

C: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

Model response: Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Hospitality and Tourism English

Professional audience: hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Original fictional case: A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Language workshop: Repair a misunderstanding

Communication goal: Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Language guidance: Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): My earlier message did not make ... clear. / I'm sorry for The correct information is / Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Vocabulary: check-in: The process of registering an arrival; also a short meeting to review progress. / room inventory: The rooms available for sale or assignment under the property's current status definitions. / upgrade: A move to a higher service category, room type, or product capability. / service recovery: Actions taken to address a service failure and restore the customer's experience.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level